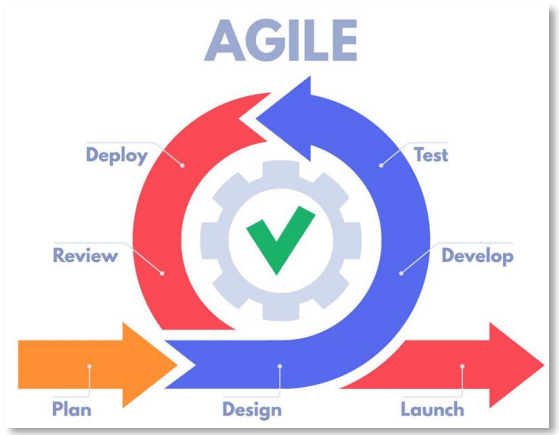
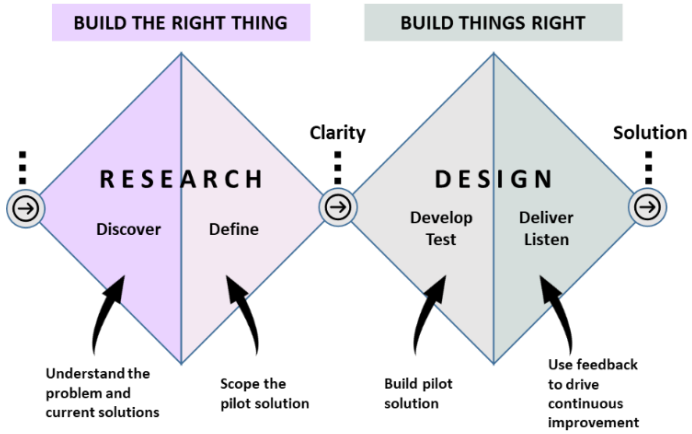
"Why Flow Matters for Engineering Leadership”

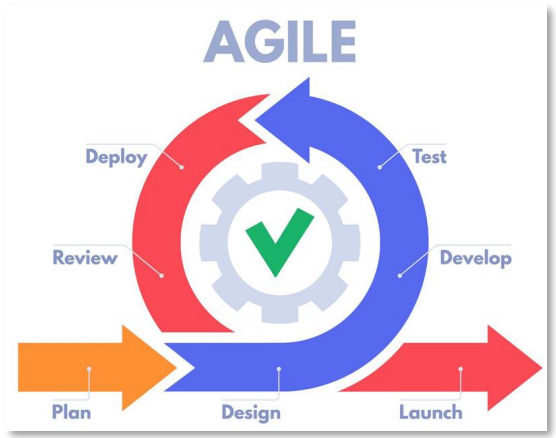
•Empowering teams to deliver value faster, with confidence.
•Aligning product development with evolving stakeholder and user needs.
•Accelerating innovation through integrated Agile + HCD practice.

"Software gets built the way cities get built: block by block, neighborhood by neighborhood, over time."
— Rich Hickey

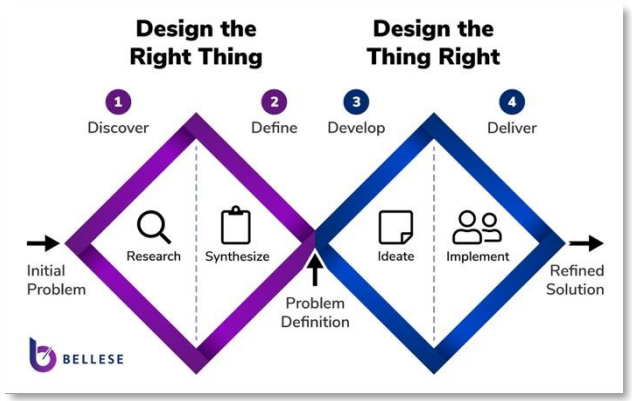




There are 3 table stakes for implementing Agile and HCD



HCD



Cyclical Iteration

Key Agile is a cyclical, iterative design process. This *explore*, *integrate*, and *deploy* cycle is at the heart of HCD as well. While the cadences of this iteration do not align out of the box, this shared commitment can be the basis for building more commensurate rhythms for development.

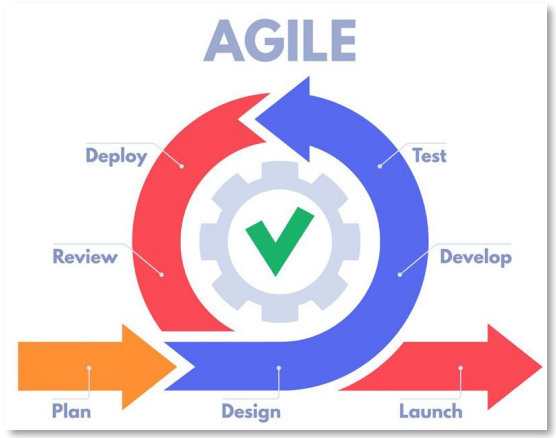
Release on Demand

A core tenet of Agile is Release on Demand (ROD). The concept of a Continuous Delivery Pipeline is also at the heart of both Agile and as it turns out, also HCD. Human-centered design is dependent upon user feedback driving iterative design. The faster we can implement these insights, the better the experience will be for the users.

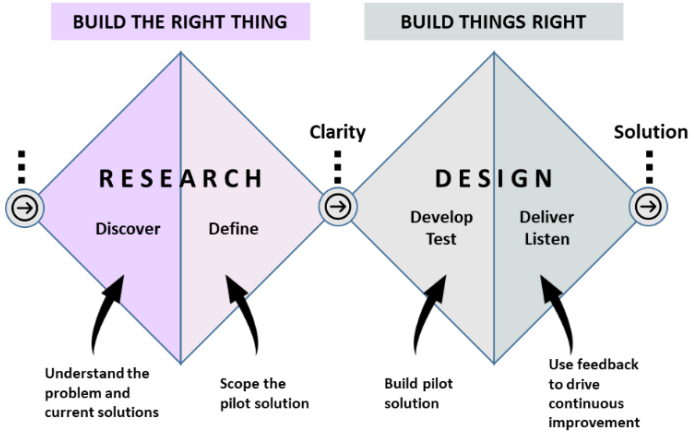
Real-World Feedback

Agile thrives on continuous stakeholder input to refine and improve solutions. HCD relies on real user experiences to drive meaningful design changes. Similarly. This ongoing loop of feedback and refinement ensures that products remain relevant, user-centric, and high quality.

Our definition of Quality of the Engineering should be based on how well do we align, enable, and accelerate these processes



HCD

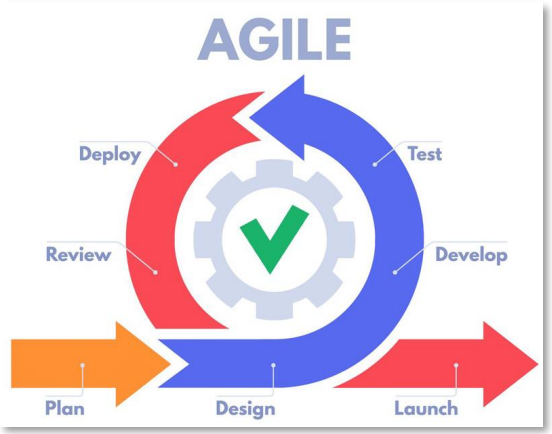


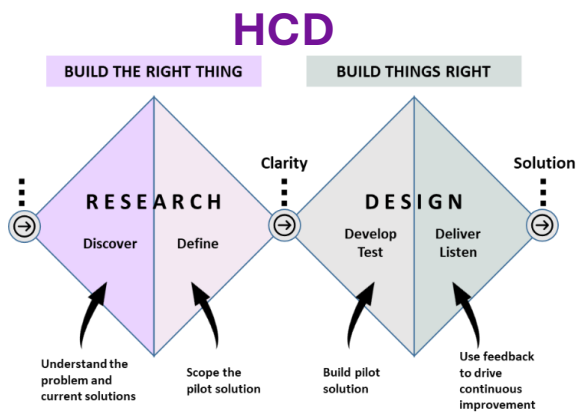
- Cyclical Iteration
- Release on Demand
- Real-World Feedback

Flow Optimized Engineering

The Engineering Designed for Flow Process aligns to the HCD and Agile processes

Flow Optimized Engineering

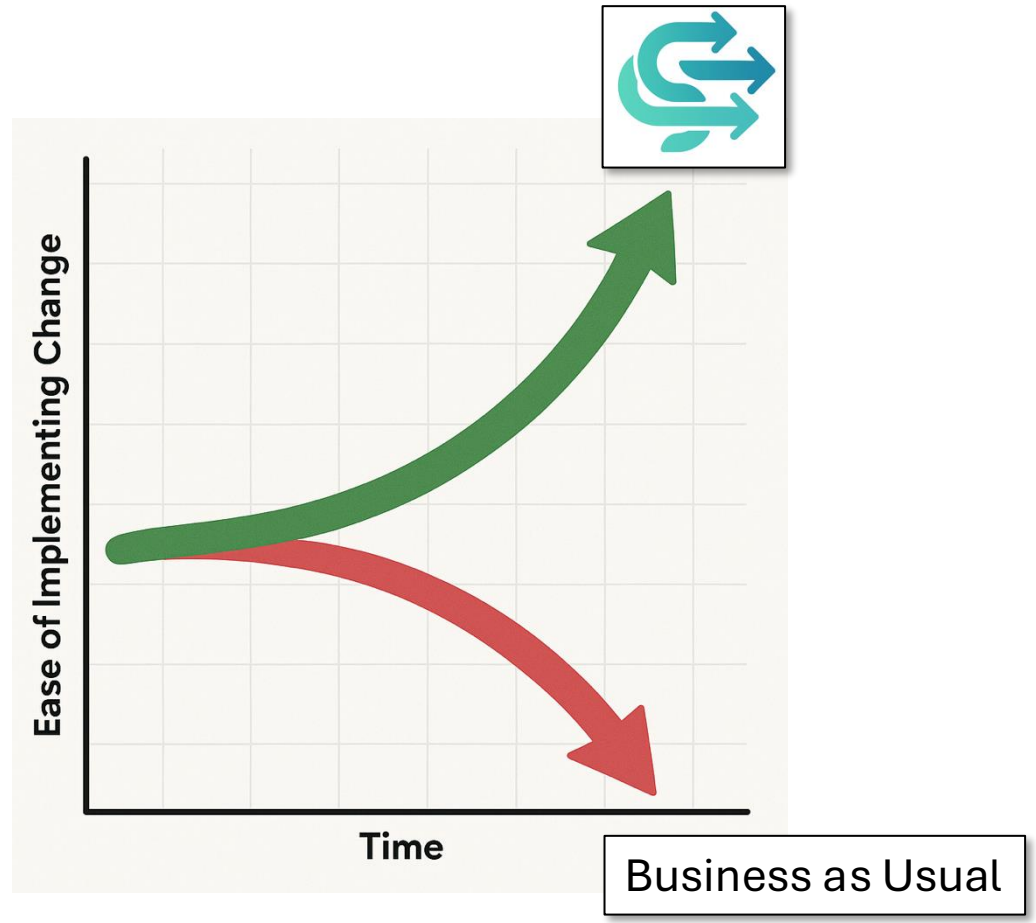




Flow Optimized Engineering

is about one thing:

Is implementing change measurably easier over time or not?



Three Pillars for the Designed to Flow Engineering Value System



Flow Optimized Engineering

1 Optimize for Understanding

- Make it easy for every stakeholder to gain understanding of what your product does, how it does it, and how to contribute to making it better

2 Optimize for Fast Feedback

- Make it easy to implement change to the product and to gain real world insights to make decisions based on empirical data

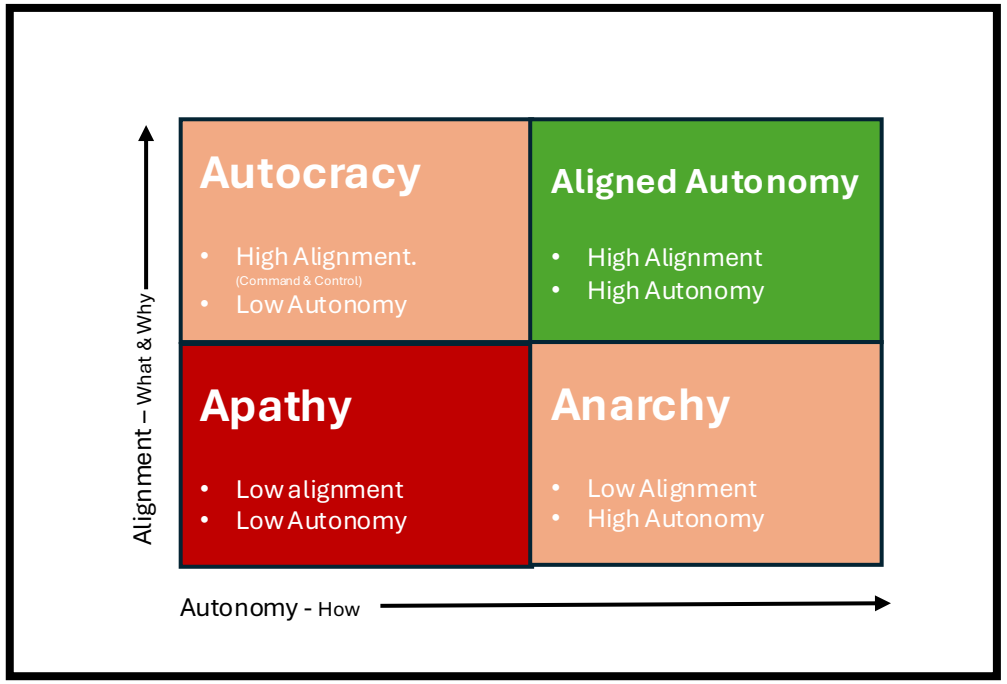
3 Optimize for Confidence

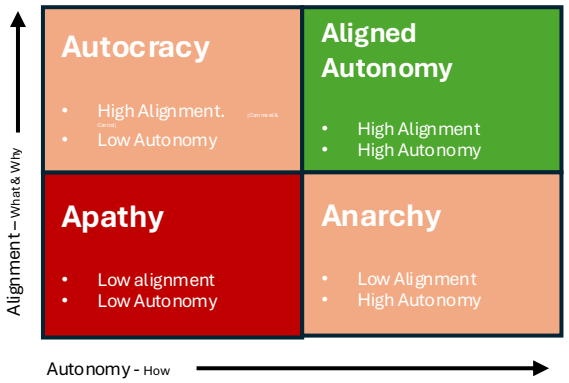
- Ensure that we **”show the receipts”** in the quality of the building of the product to ensure confidence and trust in the process

Aligning Engineering Towards The Values of Flow

describe the **What** and **Why**, <u>not</u> the **How**

Flow Optimized Engineering





Flow Optimized Engineering

Optimize for Understanding

Optimize for Fast Feedback

Optimize for Confidence

What

- Clear Documentation and Visuals
- Collaborative Practices

- Automated Testing and Deployment
- Real Time Monitoring
- Modular Architecture

- Testing and Validation
- CICD Pipelines
- Deployment Strategies
- Modular Architecture

How

OpenAPI
Pair Programing
Mermaid Diagrams
DocGen
Ai generated training
Service Mesh

Automated Testing
Contract Testing
CICD
Security Scans
Container Architecture
Kubernetes

Canary Deployments
Test Coverage
Deployment Portals
Static Code Analytics
Peer Review